ProGuide Portal Review

Features of the Admin, Mentor and Mentee portals, with suggested improvements
Application reviewed: http://127.0.0.1:5000 · 17 October 2026

About this report

This report lists every page and option in the three ProGuide portals, then suggests improvements for each one. It is based on a full read of the application source code (routes, forms, templates and data model), checked against the running instance at 127.0.0.1:5000. Each improvement has a priority:

- **High** - a bug, a security or privacy gap, or a core workflow that cannot be completed.
- **Medium** - a missing capability users will clearly expect.
- **Low** - polish and usability.

Key findings

- **Several workflows stop halfway.** Mentees can raise concerns, but nobody in any role can respond to them or change their status. Mentors can assign actions, but mentees cannot update their progress, so the mentee progress bar always stays at 0%.
- **Messaging recipients are not limited to the mentoring relationship.** A mentor's inbox lists every user, including other mentors' mentees and admins. A mentee's inbox lists every active mentor. The people-search feature is limited correctly, but the inbox is not.
- **Mentor allocation has a bug.** It always records user ID 1 as the admin who made the change, and it does not check that the chosen user is actually a mentor.
- **Admin substitutions have no checks.** Dates, overlaps and unassigned mentees are not validated, which can cause a server error. The mentor-side version of the same feature does have these checks.
- **Several stored fields are never shown or edited:** meeting notes, concern comments, action feedback, review dates and allocation history.

Shared features (all roles)

Feature	What it does
Sign in by role	The user picks Admin, Mentor or Mentee, then enters a username and password, with an optional *Remember me*. Repeated failed attempts lock the account and IP address for 15 minutes.
Forgot / reset password	The user enters their username, registered email and role to receive a single-use reset link by email. The new password must meet the password policy, and resetting signs the user out of every session.
Forced password change	Accounts created or reset by an admin must change their password at the next sign-in.
Profile	Read-only view of name, username, email, role and account status, with a link to *Change password*.
Notifications	A bell icon with an unread count. The panel shows up to 50 unread items and can be refreshed. Items are marked read one at a time.
Command search (Ctrl+K)	Jump to any page in the menu, or search people by name. Results are limited by role.
Messages / inbox	Chat threads showing delivered and read status, with an optional *Mark as emergency* flag that sends an extra alert. Messages are limited to 500 characters and each thread shows the last 100 messages.

Feature	What it does
Appearance & onboarding	A dark-mode toggle and a three-step welcome tour on first visit to the dashboard.

Admin portal

Platform-wide management of users, mentor matching, substitutions, oversight and auditing.

Functions & options

Page	Options available
Dashboard	Totals for users, active mentors, active mentees and sessions this month (with the number awaiting approval). A six-month chart of new users and sessions. Follow-up cards for pending session requests, open concerns and mentor matching. The 10 most recent audit entries. An *Add a user* button.
User management	Lists every account with name, username, role, status and last login. Per-user actions: **Activate/Deactivate** (ends that user's sessions), **Reset password** (shows a one-time temporary password), and **Delete account** (with a confirmation; removes the user and all related records; you cannot delete yourself or the last active admin).
New user	Create a Mentor or Mentee with a username, full name, optional email and optional temporary password (one is generated if left blank). The password is shown only once, and the user must change it at first login.
Import students	Download an Excel template (username, full_name, email, mentor_username). Upload an .xlsx file of up to 5 MB and 500 rows. Every row is checked first, and nothing is imported if any row fails. On success, a credentials CSV with a unique temporary password for each student is downloaded.
Mentor matching	Lists active mentees with their current mentor. Pick a mentor from a dropdown and click **Assign**. The mentee is notified and the change is saved to the allocation history.
Substitutions	Assign a temporary substitute mentor to a mentee, with a reason and start and end dates. Lists all substitutions (mentee, mentor, substitute, reason).
Concerns	Read-only list of all concerns (mentee, title, priority, status, date created).
Reports & analytics	One bar chart showing the number of mentors, mentees and meetings.
Audit log	Full, unpaginated log of events: time, user, action and details.

Suggested improvements

Improvement	Detail	Priority
Fix allocation attribution & validation	*assign_mentor* saves changed_by_id=1 and writes the audit entry as user 1, whoever is signed in. Use current_user.id instead. Also check that the chosen mentor_id is an active user with the mentor role; today any user ID is accepted.	**High**
Validate admin substitutions	Add the checks the mentor version already has: end date on or after start date, and no overlapping active substitution. Block mentees with no mentor, because mentor_id is required and saving it as empty causes a server error. Also add an audit log entry.	**High**
Concern handling	Admins can see concerns but cannot act on them. Add status changes (Open, In progress, Resolved, Closed), comments using the existing *comments* field, reassignment and escalation, plus filters by status and priority.	**High**
Prevent self-lockout	*toggle_user* lets an admin deactivate their own account or the last active admin. Delete already blocks this; apply the same rule here.	**High**

Improvement	Detail	Priority
Correct audit actor	User create, toggle and reset audit entries are recorded against the target user, not the admin who did it. Record both the actor and the target.	**Medium**
Edit user & email checks	Add an Edit page (name, email, role, mentor). On *New user*, check for a duplicate email (currently a server error) and allow choosing a mentor when creating a mentee. The form already loads the mentor list but never uses it.	**Medium**
Meetings oversight	The *Session requests* card links to the stats page, which has no list of meetings. Add an admin meetings page with filters for status, mentor and date range.	**Medium**
Richer analytics & export	Add mentor workload (mentees per mentor), unassigned mentees, meeting approval rate and turnaround time, concern resolution time and action completion rate. Allow CSV or PDF export.	**Medium**
Manage substitutions	Show dates and active status in the list, allow ending or editing a substitution, and notify both mentors, not just the mentee.	**Medium**
Allocation tools	Show allocation history, which is stored but never displayed. Add a way to unassign, bulk reassign (for example when a mentor leaves), and show each mentor's mentee count.	**Medium**
Search, filter, paginate	The users, audit and concerns tables load every row. Add search, role and status filters, paging, and audit log export.	**Low**
Confirmations	Ask for confirmation before Deactivate and Reset password, as Delete already does.	**Low**

Mentor portal

Supporting assigned mentees through sessions, assignments, concern review and messaging.

Functions & options

Page	Options available
Dashboard	Totals for my mentees, upcoming sessions and pending requests, plus an *Average rating* card that is a placeholder ('—'). Lists the next 5 upcoming sessions (with a link to manage each), the 5 most recent messages (emergency messages highlighted) and the 10 most recent assignments with how many mentees each was assigned to. A *Schedule a session* button.
My mentees	Table of assigned mentees showing name, email and last activity (last login).
Meetings	**Create a meeting**: choose all active mentees or selected mentees, then the date (today or later), time (typed as text), duration (15 to 240 minutes), mode (Online or In person) and agenda. Each mentee gets their own approved session and a notification. **Requests & scheduled meetings** table with a *Manage* button on each row. The menu shows a count of pending requests.
Manage meeting	Shows the mentee, date and time, mode and agenda. Choose a decision (Approve, Reject or Reschedule) with an optional reason. The mentee is notified. A confirmation appears before rejecting.
Substitutions	Arrange a substitute mentor (any other active mentor) for one of your mentees, with a reason and dates. Overlapping dates are checked. Existing substitutions can be edited (substitute, reason, dates, active on/off), and the mentee is notified.
Actions & assignments	Lists the actions you created (title, deadline, description). **New action**: title, description, deadline and a checklist of mentees (all ticked by default). Each chosen mentee gets an assignment and a notification.
Concerns	Read-only list of your mentees' concerns (mentee, title, priority, status).
Messages	Lists your mentees, each with an *Open chat* button that opens the shared inbox.

Suggested improvements

Improvement	Detail	Priority
Respond to concerns	This is where concerns should be resolved, but the page is read-only. Add a concern detail view with replies (using the *comments* field), status changes and notifications to the mentee.	**High**
Track & review assignments	Show each mentee's status and progress for every action, and let the mentor give feedback and mark it reviewed. The *feedback* and *reviewed_at* fields exist but are unused. Add edit and delete for actions, and block deadlines in the past.	**High**
Limit message recipients	The shared inbox lets a mentor message *any* user, including mentees who are not theirs. Limit it to assigned mentees, current substitute mentees and admins, as the search API already does.	**High**
Real rescheduling	Choosing *Reschedule* only changes the status. Ask for a proposed new date and time and let the mentee accept it. Add *Completed*, *Cancelled* and *No-show* outcomes.	**Medium**
Session notes	Let mentors record notes and follow-ups after a meeting, using the existing *notes* field, and optionally share a summary with the mentee.	**Medium**

Improvement	Detail	Priority
Substitute visibility	A mentor covering another mentor's mentees does not see them on the dashboard, mentee list or meetings. Show them in a clearly labelled 'Covering' section.	**Medium**
Mentee profile page	Make each mentee clickable to show their meetings, actions and progress, concerns and message history in one place.	**Medium**
Better scheduling input	Replace the free-text time field with a time picker, warn about double-booking, and offer calendar (.ics) export or sync.	**Low**
Messages page shortcut	*Open chat* opens the inbox without selecting that mentee. Pass recipient_id so the right thread opens.	**Low**
Rating card	Either add post-session feedback from mentees or remove the placeholder *Average rating* card.	**Low**
Text encoding fix	The empty-state text on My mentees shows 'theyâ€™ll' instead of "they'll". Re-save the template as UTF-8.	**Low**

Mentee portal

Booking sessions, following tasks from the mentor, raising concerns and staying in touch.

Functions & options

Page	Options available
Dashboard	Hero banner with a *Book a session* button. **My mentor** card (shows a substitute and their end date when one is active) with a link to messages. **Next session** card showing date, time, mode, agenda and status. **Goals & progress**: percentage of actions completed and the 5 most recent tasks. **Learning resources**: a 'coming soon' placeholder that suggests asking your mentor.
Book a session	Request a meeting with your assigned mentor: date, time, duration, mode (Online or Offline) and agenda. It is created as *Pending* and the mentor is notified. This is blocked if no mentor is assigned.
My sessions	Lists all meetings (mentor, date, status, agenda) with a *Request meeting* button.
Tasks & progress	Read-only list of assigned actions (title, status, progress %, notes).
My concerns	Raise a concern with a title, category (Academic, Personal, Project or Other), priority (Low, Medium or High) and description. Your mentor is notified. Lists your concerns (title, category, status).
Messages	Shows your mentor's name and an *Open inbox* button for the shared chat.

Suggested improvements

Improvement	Detail	Priority
Update task progress	Mentees cannot change the status, progress or notes on an action, so the dashboard progress bar never moves. Add Start, Update progress and Submit (setting *submitted_at*), and show the mentor's feedback.	**High**
Validate meeting requests	Requests accept dates in the past and any duration (0 or 10,000 minutes). Apply the same rules as the mentor form: today or later, and 15 to 240 minutes.	**High**
Limit message recipients	The inbox lists every active mentor. Limit it to the assigned mentor and any active substitute.	**High**
Concern follow-up	Show the mentor's replies and status history, let mentees add details or close a concern, and show priority in the list.	**Medium**
Manage own sessions	Let mentees cancel or reschedule a pending request, and show time, duration, mode and the mentor's decision reason, which is stored but not shown.	**Medium**
Deadlines & reminders	Show due dates on the Tasks page, highlight overdue items, and send reminders before deadlines and sessions.	**Medium**
Learning resources	Replace the placeholder with resources the mentor or admin can share (links and files) that are linked to tasks.	**Low**
Editable profile	Let mentees update their email and contact details (with verification), and see their mentor and substitute.	**Low**
Session feedback	After a session is completed, ask for a quick rating and comment. This also feeds the mentor's rating card.	**Low**

Platform-wide improvements

Improvement	Detail	Priority
Notifications	Add *Mark all read*, a full notification history page, links from each notification to the related item, and optional email alerts for meetings, emergency messages and new concerns.	**Medium**
Consistent status model	Define the allowed statuses for meetings, actions and concerns in one place and show consistent status pills. Some tables use status|lower without replacing spaces, so multi-word statuses get the wrong style.	**Low**
Pin front-end dependencies	Chart.js is loaded from a CDN without a version. Pin an exact version (with an SRI hash) or serve it locally.	**Low**
Pagination everywhere	Every list page loads all rows. Add paging so the app stays fast as data grows.	**Low**
Accessibility pass	The newer pages have good ARIA support. Bring the older Bootstrap tables and forms (concerns, substitutions, actions) up to the same standard with labels, captions and error messages.	**Low**

Suggested order of work

Phase	Includes
1. Fix correctness & privacy	Allocation actor and role check; admin substitution validation; self-deactivation guard; messaging recipient limits; mentee meeting validation.
2. Finish the core workflows	Concern responses and status changes for mentors and admins; mentee task progress with mentor review; real rescheduling and meeting outcomes.
3. Visibility & insight	Admin meetings page, richer analytics and export, allocation history, mentee profile page and substitute visibility.
4. Polish	Pagination and filters, notification history, time picker, resources, feedback and ratings, encoding and dependency fixes.